

Salty seas

The world's oceans are salty because they contain a lot of dissolved chemicals that scientists call salts. Drinking water also contains salts, but only in small amounts, so you can't taste them.

The Dead Sea contains so much salt that people can just float on the surface.

Surviving in salt water

Countless animals live in water. They don't drink, but take water into their bodies in other ways. Fish often absorb water as it washes in and out of their gills. Salt-water fish absorb only a little of the salt.

Hands on

Put an egg in a glass of water. The egg will sink. Start stirring in salt until the egg rises. The egg will eventually float because salt water is denser than fresh water.

Estuary life

An estuary is the wide part of a river where it nears the sea. When the tide comes in, salt water flows into the estuary. When the tide goes out, the estuary contains mostly fresh water from the river or stream that flows into it. Mangrove trees like these are able to live in the changing estuary water.

